

Robin Rowland

PhD Candidate | Wildlife Ecology

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University of the Sunshine Coast
LinkedIn

Key Skills

Data management | Statistical analysis (R)
Project coordination |
Stakeholder engagement |
Scientific communication

Wildlife ecologist with demonstrated experience in data management, technical analysis and reporting, and stakeholder engagement across academic, government, and community partners. Skilled in maintaining large ecological datasets and communicating complex scientific information to diverse audiences. Proven project coordination and committee experience, with strong statistical analysis skills in R.

Education

2023–Present	Doctor of Philosophy University of the Sunshine Coast <i>Thesis: Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats</i> Anticipated completion December 2026
2012–2016	Bachelor of Arts (Honours Program), Animal Behaviour Eckerd College, USA

Relevant Experience

2023-Feb–Present	PhD Researcher, University of the Sunshine Coast, QLD - Lead a research project examining the effects of urbanisation and roost environments on insectivorous bat health and physiology. - Developed an open-access continental-scale database of Australian bat roost associations and a complementary functional-trait database. - Work with private landholders, non-profit organisations, state and local government, and communicate findings to stakeholders. - Mentor and assist with supervision and experimental design of six student research projects (three undergraduate, three honours).
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- 2024-Oct–Present **Bat Walk Workshop Leader, Moreton Bay Council, QLD**
- Organise and lead annual citizen science bat walks and public workshops.
- 2024-Mar–Present **Student Scholar, GBatNet Global Union of Bat Diversity Networks**
- Participate in international working groups and meetings involving bat researchers, conservation practitioners and other specialists.
 - Collaborate on a global review of Data Deficient bat species, including creation, cleaning and management of a large citation database.
 - Contribute to development of globally relevant scientific communication guidelines as part of a Global Bat Communication Guidelines Working Group.
- 2023-Mar–Present **Tutor, University of the Sunshine Coast, QLD**
ANM100 — Animal Ecology Field Course (×3)
- Deliver course content on bat acoustics and provide support and instruction for first-year university students during field courses to North Stradbroke Island (Minjerrabah).
 - Demonstrate ecological field techniques including transects, acoustic monitoring and animal identification across diverse terrains.
- ANM103 — Animal Form and Function (×3)**
ENS222 — Terrestrial Vertebrate Diversity & Ecology (×2)
- Instruct university students in laboratory techniques and scientific writing, moderate student discussions and mark assignments.
 - Lead student groups on annual vertebrate identification field trips.
- 2017-Aug–2023-Feb **Outreach Coordinator, Tamborine Mountain Glow Worm Caves, QLD**
- Liaised with tour and school groups, production companies and news agencies to deliver tailored wildlife conservation information in a fast-paced environment.
 - Represented the organisation at academic conferences and in communication with the public and scientific community through emails, reports and reviews.

2019-Aug–2019-Nov **Volunteer, Southern Cross University Glider Program, Brisbane QLD**

- Captured, collected and recorded data from wild squirrel and sugar glider individuals.
- Installed and removed Elliott traps at study sites around the Brisbane area.

2016-Jun–2016-Nov **Research Intern, Busch Gardens Animal Research Center, USA**

- Collected and analysed behavioural, physiological and parasite data on a range of mammalian and avian species.
- Coordinated with researchers to design novel experiments and deliver results from multiple parallel projects to internal and external stakeholders.

2015-May–2015-Aug **Research Intern, Savannah State University Dolphin Science Lab, USA**

- Collected behavioural and environmental data on bottlenose dolphin individuals during weekly field surveys and assisted with database updates and maintenance.
- After the internship concluded, worked remotely with the lab to complete a study examining injury rates in local dolphin populations.

Service Roles

2026	Bats in Buildings Working Group Member Contributed to FAQ resource for Australian land managers and public
2026	UniSC HDR Retreat Organising Committee Event planning and logistics, including scheduling, correspondence and bookings
2025-Present	Treasurer, UniSC Ecological Society Facilitate meetings, budget acquittals and event coordination
2020-2024	Committee Member, Wildlife Preservation Society of QLD - Scenic Rim Workshop and volunteer coordination
2019-Present	Wildlife Rescuer & Workshop Co-Lead, Bats Queensland Co-lead and facilitate annual educational workshops on insectivorous bat rehabilitation

Grants and Awards

2024-2026	Holsworth Wildlife Research Endowment \$20,720 AUD — Insectivorous Bats in South East Queensland [Lead Author]
2025	GBatNet Global Union of Bat Diversity Networks \$21,851 AUD — Data Deficient Bat Working Group Funding [Co-investigator]
2024	WIRES National Research Grant \$49,586 AUD — Establishing vital roost characteristics to facilitate urban insectivorous bat conservation [Co-investigator]
2023	Holohil Transmitter Grant Program Radio \$2,720 AUD — Transmitters for Insectivorous Bats [Lead Author]
2021	Landcare Led Bushfire Recovery Grants \$49,000 AUD — Wildlife Corridors in the Scenic Rim [Lead Author]
2020	Logan EnviroGrants \$1,950 AUD — Educational Workshops and Events for Bat Carers [Lead Author]
2020	Logan EnviroGrants \$9,900 AUD — ICUs for Bat Carers Capacity Building [Lead Author]
2023	Wildlife Acoustics Scientific Product Grant \$1,197 AUD — Bat Roost Identification [Lead Author]

Invited Seminars

2026-Apr	Urban Bat Ecology. GBatNet 'My Field for Dummies' Online Series.
2025-Oct	Bats in Our Backyards - Get to Know Our Nocturnal Neighbours. University of the Third Age Sunshine Coast.
2025-Jul	Introduction to Zotero and Scientific Citations, UniSC Ecological Society.
2024-Sep	Ecological Careers Workshop, UniSC Ecological Society.

Presentations and Posters

2026-Aug	Physiological tools for monitoring urban impacts at the roost level in insectivorous bats. Joint Conference of the Australian Mammal Society and Australasian Bat Society, Australia.
2025-Nov	Bats Are In The Building: Understanding Anthropogenic Roost Selection Through Habitat Models. Ecological Society of Australia Conference. Australia.
2025-Dec	Stressed out bats: developing tools to monitor physiological stress in three insectivorous species. Australian and New Zealand Society for Comparative Physiology and Biochemistry Meeting, Australia.
2025-Aug	No one size fits all: Exploring Anthropogenic roost selection across an Urban Gradient in South East Queensland. 20th International Bat Research Conference, Australia.
2025-Aug	The system works: post-release survival of rehabilitated insectivorous bats in Australia. 20th International Bat Research Conference, Australia.
2025-Jul	Home is where the bats are: Bats in man-made structures in South East Queensland. Animal Ecology Seminar Series, The University of the Sunshine Coast, Australia.
2024-Apr	From rugs to rocky overhangs: diverse microclimates of natural and anthropogenic bat roosts in South East Queensland. 21st Australasian Bat Society Conference, Australia.
2024-Apr	Roosting Ecology of Australian Insectivorous Bats, a Public Dataset (Poster). Australasian Bat Society Conference. Australia. *Runner Up Student Poster.
2024-Oct	Roosting Ecology of Australian Insectivorous Bats, a Public Dataset (Poster). North American Bat Society Conference, Mexico.
2023-Nov	Working with Bat Landlords to Study the Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats

in South East Queensland. Australian Citizen Science Conference, Australia.

2020-Feb

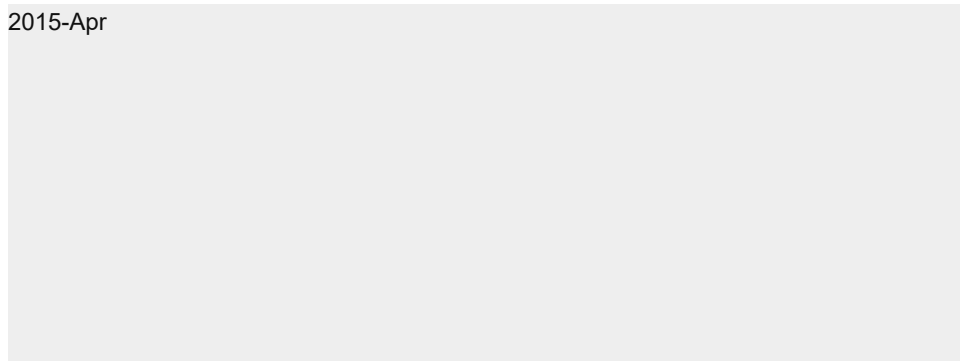
The Success of a Wildlife Corridor on Tamborine Mountain and the Value of Landcare

2019-Dec

The Scenic Rim and Its Potential Role as an Ethical Wildlife Tourism Destination. The
2018-Oct

Can Glow-worm Ecotourism Lead to Increased Conservation Knowledge and Positiv

2015-Apr



2016-Apr

Science Communication

2026-Jan	Commenting on Noosa Flying Fox Mass Entanglement Event. ABC Sunshine Coast Radio, Wide Bay, Southern Queensland
2026-Jan	Commenting on Annual Influx of Little Red Flying Foxes in the Region. ABC Sunshine Coast Radio
2024-Aug	Commenting on Arson Incident on Moloolah Valley bat colony. ABC Sunshine Coast, ABC Australia (https://www.abc.net.au/news/2024-08-28/ars)

2024-Jul	Microbats. Chicken Nuggets, Stress and Wildlife Rescue! TalkECO Podcast (https://open.spotify.com/episode/2CKIDzUEnoRh8V33f3JMRy?si=SQ1X5U1rS2q_-QFs9SO9w)
2024-Feb	Study to help save mini bats that fly under the radar. Sunshine Coast News (https://www.sunshinecoastnews.com.au/2024/02/23/study-to-help-save-tiny-bats-that-fly-under-the-radar/)
2024-Feb	Research to Save Tiny Bats from Housing Crisis. ABC Sunshine Coast Breakfast Radio
2023-Jul	Little Forest Bats: Earths Tiniest Heroes, Australian Mammal of the Year Profile. Cosmos Magazine (https://cosmosmagazine.com/nature/amoty/little-forest-bats-earths-tiniest-heroes/)

Outreach

2026-Mar	Bat Workshop and Echolocation Walk, Moreton Bay Council.
2026-Mar	Invited Speaker and Exhibit Consultant. Queensland Museum Bat Night Market Exhibit. World Science Festival Brisbane.
2025-Nov	Bats in Buildings on the Sunshine Coast. Maleny Bat Night hosted by the Sunshine Coast Council.
2025-Oct	Bats of the Sunshine Coast Workshop and Bat Walk. Mooloolah River Landcare.
2025-Oct	Bats in Your Backyard: Crash Course to the Bats of SEQ. 'What's Brewing Behind the Dunes Series', Coolum CoastCare.
2024-Nov	Bat Workshop and Spotlighting Walk. UniSC Ecological Society.
2024-Oct	Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats. Maleny Bat Night hosted by the Sunshine Coast Council.
2024-Oct	Bat Workshop and Echolocation Walk, Moreton Bay Council.
2024-Sep	Bat Call Walk and Workshop Leader. Springfield Lakes Nature Centre.
2024-May	Bats and Forests: We Need Bats More Than You Think! Maleny Wood Expo, Maleny, QLD

2024-Apr	Bat Call Walk Leader, Microbat Discovery Walk Series. Brisbane Catchments Network.
2023-Oct	Sunshine Coast Citizen Science Bat Walk, Sunshine Coast BioBlitz.

Skills and Certifications

Statistical analysis in R — linear modelling, mixed modelling, and spatial modelling with temporal and spatial autocorrelation

Operate and Maintain 4WD Vehicle (RIIVEH305F)

Provide Advanced Resuscitation and Oxygen Therapy First Aid (HLTAID015)

Provide Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation — CPR (HLTAID009)

Referees

Dr. Clare Stawski

Primary Supervisor — Senior Lecturer, University of the Sunshine Coast

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Dr. Alexis Levengood

Co-Supervisor and Field Course Leader — Research Fellow, University of the Sunshine Coast

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